

WELCOME TO THE EXPERIMENT

Give an AI a virtual ₹1,00,000. Let it make simulated decisions on Indian stocks. Track every win, loss, and lesson over 15 trading days.

FOR BEGINNERS

No real money, no mandatory broker account, and a free rules-only mode to start.

FOR AI EXPERIMENTERS

Connect Claude Code or an Anthropic API key to test AI-generated BUY / SELL / HOLD decisions.

GET THE SOFTWARE

Download code + read updated instructions (GitHub)

Optional Claude setup walkthrough

READ THIS FIRST

This is a paper-trading experiment. ₹1,00,000 is virtual. Prices may be delayed; fills, slippage and charges are simulated. No real buy or sell orders are placed.

01 / BEFORE YOU START

What you are actually downloading

A local Windows/Mac application built for experimenting with trading decisions, not a live brokerage terminal.

WHAT IT DOES	WHAT IT DOES NOT DO
Tracks virtual cash and positions, watches a market-data feed, generates simulated orders and shows portfolio P&L.	Does not send buy/sell orders to a broker, deposit real funds, promise profits, or provide investment recommendations.

You will need

- A Windows or Mac computer, internet connection, and Python 3.11 or newer.
- The project ZIP from GitHub. You do not need a broker account for the default Yahoo-data mode.
- Optional: Claude Code login or an Anthropic API key if you want AI decisions. Otherwise, the free built-in rules strategy is available.
- An awake computer during market hours if you want it to keep observing prices automatically.

The 4-step journey

01 Install

Download the ZIP, extract it, and run the installer for your operating system.

02 Try demo

Run an offline test with fictional prices to make sure the interface and engine work.

03 Choose brain + settings

Select Claude or the rules baseline, then check ₹1,00,000 capital and 15-session duration.

04 Start a paper challenge

Run during Indian market hours; check the logs, simulated fills, and final result every evening.

IMPORTANT LANGUAGE

“Real market prices” means quotes from a market-data service. In the default setup they may be delayed, incomplete, or incorrect. A simulated trade price is not proof of a fill available in the actual market.

02 / WINDOWS SETUP

Install on Windows

Follow these exact steps if you are using a Windows laptop or PC.

01 Install Python

Open python.org/downloads, install Python 3.11 or newer, and select “Add python.exe to PATH” if the installer offers it.

Official Python download: python.org/downloads

02 Download the project

Open the Breaking Money GitHub page. Click the green Code button → Download ZIP. Extract the ZIP into a normal folder, such as Documents. Avoid running scripts directly inside the compressed ZIP.

Project download: Breaking Money Trading Agent

03 Run setup

Inside the extracted project folder, double-click setup.bat. This creates a local Python environment and installs the required packages. Keep the window open until you see “Setup done.”

```
setup.bat
```

04 Launch the Arena

Double-click START-TRADING.bat in the same folder. Your default web browser should open the local control panel.

```
START-TRADING.bat
```

05 Test safely before starting

Run the demo from a terminal opened inside the project folder, or use the provided demo option when available. Demo prices are fictional, not historical results.

```
.venv\Scripts\python -m arena demo
```

IF WINDOWS WARNS ABOUT A DOWNLOADED SCRIPT

Only run code from a source you trust. Review the GitHub files or have a technically knowledgeable person inspect them first. No installer can guarantee the safety of third-party software.

03 / MACOS SETUP

Install on Mac

A one-time Terminal setup lets you run the same local trading dashboard.

01 Install Python

Install Python 3.11 or newer from python.org/downloads. Confirm that python3 works in Terminal.

```
python3 --version
```

02 Get the project

Download the ZIP from GitHub and extract it. Open Terminal in the extracted project directory (or navigate to it using cd).

03 Install dependencies

From inside that directory, run the command below. It creates a local virtual environment and installs the project packages.

```
chmod +x setup.sh start-trading.command
./setup.sh
```

04 Open the Arena

Use the launch script after setup. The browser-based control panel should open locally.

```
./start-trading.command
```

05 Try the offline demo

If you prefer a safe, quick test first, run:

```
.venv/bin/python -m arena demo
```

If macOS blocks an executable

Try right-clicking the launch file and choosing Open, or use the Terminal commands above. Do not disable macOS security protections system-wide.

NO BACKGROUND SERVER REQUIRED

The Arena runs on your own computer. Your computer needs to remain running and connected during the live-session experiment; turning it off pauses the bot.

04 / CHOOSE YOUR TRADING BRAIN

Claude mode vs free mode

The platform has three decision engines. Pick one based on the experience you want and your available tools.

MODE	WHAT YOU NEED	WHAT MAKES DECISIONS
Claude Code	Installed Claude Code + logged-in, eligible account	Claude generates BUY / SELL / HOLD suggestions; usage limits may apply.
Anthropic API	Your own API key and API billing	Claude API generates decisions; usage is billed separately.
Rules baseline	No AI account or API key	Deterministic momentum rules; free to run, but not Claude.

The default setting is brain = "auto" in config.toml. The app attempts Claude Code, then an API key, then rules. Confirm which mode is actually active before sharing “AI bot” results.

Configuration checklist

- Open Settings in the dashboard. Starting virtual capital: ₹1,00,000.
- Challenge duration: 15 trading sessions, not necessarily 15 calendar days.
- Select Balanced or Aggressive profile; the latter takes greater simulated risk.
- Pick your watchlist and intraday/delivery mode. V1 is long-only: BUY opens and SELL closes positions.
- Optionally add a strategy note, such as “Only trade confirmed breakouts above opening range.”

Optional: connect Claude via API

The installer creates a local .env file. Paste an API key there only if you choose API mode. Never post your API key in comments, videos, screenshots, GitHub or shared files.

```
ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=your_private_api_key
```

RUN A QUICK DIAGNOSTIC

Inside the project environment, use python -m arena check. It reports the active brain, data-feed status, and the paper-order safety check.

05 / RUN THE CHALLENGE

Your 15-trading-day playbook

Start with a dry run. Then keep the rules and the records transparent across the full challenge.

01 Before Day 1

Run the offline demo, confirm the active brain, verify your watchlist and virtual capital, and enter NSE market holidays in config.toml. Keep a copy of your starting settings.

02 Start a new run

In the GUI, click Start when ready. The command-line alternative is shown below.

```
python -m arena run --new --name "Breaking Money Challenge"
```

03 During Indian market hours

The default window is 09:15–15:30 IST on trading days. The config polls for prices about every 30 seconds and requests new decisions about every 15 minutes. These settings are configurable.

04 Risk checks are automatic

Default Balanced configuration limits each position to 20% of equity, uses a 1.5% stop-loss, 3% target, and a 3% maximum daily loss. Intraday mode blocks new entries after 14:45 and targets square-off at 15:15 IST.

05 End each session with evidence

Open reports/results.html. Record starting/closing virtual equity, realized P&L, unrealized P&L, costs, trades and bot reasoning. Keep both good and bad days.

06 Repeat and finish

The same challenge can resume with saved cash/positions. At 15 completed trading sessions, summarize the complete record and compare it with a suitable benchmark over the same dates.

NO CHEATING THE EXPERIMENT

If you edit strategy notes, risk limits, watchlists, or model settings mid-challenge, mark exactly when you changed them. Better yet: lock your main experiment and test new ideas in separate runs.

06 / MAKE SENSE OF THE RESULTS

What the dashboard is showing

Every reported return is from simulated execution, not from actual broker fills.

METRIC	HOW TO READ IT
Portfolio value	Remaining virtual cash plus the current marked value of open simulated positions.
Realized P&L	Profit/loss on paper positions that have been closed.
Unrealized P&L	Paper profit/loss on open positions based on the latest available quote.
Net P&L	Results after the engine's modeled charges and simulated trading friction.
Win rate / drawdown	How many closed trades won, and how far equity declined from a prior peak.
Trade journal	Decision timestamp, selected stock, BUY/SELL/HOLD reason, and simulated fill.

One simple example (illustrative only)

Suppose a paper trade buys 10 shares at a simulated ₹1,500 fill and later sells at a simulated ₹1,505 fill. Gross profit = 10 × ₹5 = ₹50. Net profit is lower after applicable modeled costs. Actual fills, spread, price movement, taxes and broker charges may differ.

More experiments once you are comfortable

```
python -m arena replay --days 10
python -m arena compete --brains rules,claude-api --days 10
python -m arena report
python -m arena status
```

Historical replay, competition and AI coach features depend on available history and a configured decision engine. Some commands require data or API access; not every mode is free.

ABOUT YOUR MARKET DATA

The default Yahoo Finance/yfinance feed is unofficial and for personal/educational use. It may lag, fail or contain errors. Respect the provider's terms and do not present simulated price outcomes as real trading performance.

07 / TROUBLESHOOTING

Fix the most common problems

Work through these checks before asking for help.

PROBLEM	WHAT TO TRY
Python not found	Install Python 3.11+ and enable PATH on Windows; restart the terminal. Check python --version or python3 --version.
Setup script does not run	Extract the ZIP fully, open the correct folder and rerun setup.bat or ./setup.sh.
No prices returned	Check your internet, symbol, market hours and data-source availability. Try the offline demo.
Start seems inactive	Check whether the market is open; live-session mode waits outside permitted trading times.
Claude not making decisions	Run python -m arena check, confirm the active brain, account login/API key, and plan usage limits.
Mac permission error	Run chmod +x setup.sh start-trading.command then launch from Terminal.
App closes when computer sleeps	Keep your computer awake while using the session; the local bot does not keep trading after shutdown.
Results look unrealistic	Check timestamps, input-price freshness, order costs, position sizing and the journal. Demo is synthetic.

Frequently asked questions

Is my ₹1,00,000 real? No. It is an initial virtual balance inside the simulator.

Do I need a broker account? Not for the default Yahoo-data mode; alternative feeds may require one.

Is Claude mandatory? No. The free rules baseline works without Claude, but it is not an AI strategy.

Can this place actual orders? It is designed for paper-only simulation and explicitly blocks real trading.

Will I definitely make a profit? No. A virtual challenge may show gains or losses, and the results do not predict real trading outcomes.

08 / PLEASE READ

Disclaimers, data rights & resources

You should understand the limitations before installing, sharing or relying on the results.

Educational simulation only

Breaking Money AI Trading Arena is an educational software experiment. The default ₹1,00,000 is entirely virtual. The system is designed to simulate BUY, SELL and HOLD decisions; it does not execute real-money orders. No deposit, broker account, or actual investment is necessary for the default mode.

Not investment, trading, tax or legal advice

Nothing in this guide, the application, its outputs, or related videos is a recommendation to buy or sell any security, or personalized financial advice. Breaking Money states in its repository disclaimer that it and contributors are not SEBI-registered investment advisers or research analysts. Consult an appropriately registered professional for personal advice.

Simulated returns are not real returns

Prices may be delayed, incorrect or unavailable. Execution prices, spread, slippage, market impact, fees and tax-like charges are modeled estimates, not broker-verified actual fills. Past, paper, replay or backtested performance cannot guarantee future results. Trading real securities can result in partial or total capital loss.

Market-data licensing and privacy

The default unofficial Yahoo Finance/yfinance connection is intended for personal research/education and has restrictions on redistribution and commercial use. Users are responsible for following data-provider terms. Never share an Anthropic API key or your .env file. API usage can generate charges to your personal account.

Software availability

The open-source software is supplied as-is and without warranty. Install only after reviewing the source and current README. Features, costs, dependencies, and setup instructions may change as the project evolves.

OFFICIAL BREAKING MONEY PROJECT LINKS

GitHub - Download, README, license and updates

Supplementary Claude Artifact walkthrough

If the supplementary walkthrough does not open, follow the GitHub README and this guide. The Artifact link was provided by Breaking Money and may require its sharing settings to allow access.

BREAKING MONEY

Run your own 15-day challenge. Share your learnings, not guaranteed profits. Tag Breaking Money with your simulated results.